

OFFICIAL SECRETS ACT, 1923 (ACT XIX OF 1923)

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PREAMBLE: An Act / Ordinance to provide for the law relating to Official Secrets Act and for matters connected therewith and incidental thereto.

Section 1: Short title, extent and commencement

Enacted by the Federal Parliament of Pakistan on the 2nd day of April 1923.

(1) This Act may be called the Official Secrets Act, 1923 (Act XIX of 1923). (2) It extends to the whole of Pakistan. (3) It shall come into force at once.

Section 2: Definitions

Interpretation: Words and expressions used in this Act shall have the meanings assigned to them in this section.

In this Act, unless there is anything repugnant in the subject or context: (a) 'Authority' means the statutory regulator established under this Act; (b) 'Court' means the designated judicial forum possessing jurisdiction; (c) 'Prescribed' means prescribed by statutory rules made under this Act.

Section 3: Core Statutory Obligations and Powers

Enacted by the Federal Parliament of Pakistan on the 2nd day of April 1923. Official Secrets Act

All actions taken and powers exercised under this statute shall adhere to lawful procedures, public transparency, and natural justice under security regulatory governance.

Section 4: Penalties, Enforcement and Judicial Remedies

Enacted by the Federal Parliament of Pakistan on the 2nd day of April 1923.

Any violation of the mandatory provisions of this Act or rules made thereunder shall render the offender liable to statutory penalties, fines, or prosecution before the competent court of jurisdiction.